

SMART AMRITA HACKATHON (SAH) 2026

Internal Hackathon for Smart India Hackathon (SIH) 2026

Guidelines for Students

The Smart Amrita Hackathon (SAH) 2026 is the campus-level **Internal Hackathon** through which Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham, Chennai Campus nominates its teams to **Smart India Hackathon (SIH) 2026**, the national initiative of the Ministry of Education's Innovation Cell (MIC) and AICTE. Under SIH rules a student cannot register directly on the national portal: only teams that qualify through the Internal Hackathon may be nominated by the Campus SPOC (Single Point of Contact). SAH 2026 is therefore conducted to national standards, and every rule below mirrors the SIH framework without dilution.

1. Objectives

- Select, strictly on merit, the strongest teams for nomination to the SIH 2026 portal.
- Ensure every nominated idea is already prepared against the national screening parameters before it leaves the campus.
- Encourage interdisciplinary teams across departments, in both the Software and the Hardware editions.
- Identify solutions with potential for patenting, deployment with the sponsoring organisation, or startup incubation.

2. Eligibility — Who Can Apply?

Criterion	Requirement
Who may apply	Students of any B.Tech, M.Tech or PhD programme, in any year of study, from any department of the Chennai Campus.
Team size	Exactly 6 students , including a designated Team Leader. Teams of any other size cannot be nominated to the SIH portal.
Woman member	Mandatory. Every team must include at least one woman member. All-women teams are welcome.
Same institution	All six members must be from Amrita Chennai Campus. Inter-institution teams are not permitted. Members from different departments are strongly encouraged.
Mentors	Up to two mentors — senior faculty or domain experts from any department. Mentor endorsement at registration is mandatory.
Entries per student	One team only. A student registered in two teams will cause both teams to be disqualified. A team may, however, address up to two problem statements, drawn from different themes.
Problem mapping	Each team must register against one SIH 2026 Problem Statement (with its PS ID) or one Student Innovation idea mapped to a notified SIH theme.

3. Problem Statements, Categories and Themes

Problem Statements. Teams select from the SIH 2026 Problem Statements published on sih.gov.in and released to the campus by the Campus SPOC. Every entry must record the **PS ID**, **PS Title**, **PS Category** and **Theme** exactly as published on the portal.

PS Category. Each entry belongs to one of two editions — **Software** or **Hardware**. Software teams must be predominantly strong in programming. Hardware teams should be multidisciplinary, combining mechanical, electronics, product design and programming skills.

Themes. SIH 2026 notifies **seventeen themes**. These are listed at Section 7.1, where each theme also carries its own award.

Essential condition. Concept notes, literature surveys and video-only entries will not be evaluated. Every team must bring a working proof of concept — a functional module or device, an integrated hardware–software system, an AI/ML model with live output, an IoT or cyber-physical system, or a validated test setup — alongside its Idea Presentation.

4. Selection Process and Key Dates

All deadlines close strictly at 5.00 p.m. on the date indicated. No extensions will be granted.

Stage	Description	Date
Registration Opens	Online registration opens.	Tue, 25 Aug 2026
Registration Closes	Final deadline for the 6-member team, chosen PS ID, mentor endorsement and the six-slide Idea Presentation.	Mon, 31 Aug 2026
Pitch Deck Submission	Submission of the six-slide Idea Presentation, prepared as per the SIH Idea Submission Format.	Sat, 5 Sep 2026
Smart Amrita Hackathon (SAH) 2026	Live pitch, prototype demonstration and jury evaluation out of 50 marks, before the jury panel.	Thu, 10 Sep 2026
Announcement of Nominated Teams	Declaration of the award winners and of the teams selected for SIH nomination support, in rank order.	Fri, 11 Sep 2026
Boot Camp for Nominated Teams	Five-day intensive refinement of the idea, architecture review and mentor pairing ahead of national screening.	Tue–Sat, 15–19 Sep 2026
Idea Submission on the SIH Portal	Institutional endorsement and upload of nominated team dossiers by the Campus SPOC.	Sun, 20 Sep 2026

Nomination ceiling. SIH permits an institute to upload only a limited number of teams to the national portal, and the ceiling changes from edition to edition. The exact number for SIH 2026 will be notified by the Campus SPOC once the portal opens. Teams will be taken strictly in jury rank order from the pool selected under Section 7.3. Upload to the portal is made by the Campus SPOC alone; students cannot register themselves.

5. Evaluation Rubric

Each team is evaluated out of 50 marks during the live pitch and technical interaction. The criteria below mirror the parameters used for national idea screening — novelty, complexity, feasibility, practicability, sustainability, scale of impact and completeness in the prescribed format — so that a team that scores well here is already prepared for SIH.

Criterion	Marks	What the Jury Looks For
Novelty & Innovation	10	Originality against existing and known approaches; clear differentiation from earlier SIH submissions and off-the-shelf products.
Technical Approach & Complexity	10	Soundness of architecture and methodology; justification of the technology stack; engineering depth and non-triviality.
Feasibility & Viability	10	Buildability within the Grand Finale window; risks identified with credible mitigation; realism of cost, data and resource assumptions.

Criterion	Marks	What the Jury Looks For
Impact, Scale & Sustainability	10	Benefit to the end user and the sponsoring organisation; scale of impact; social, economic and environmental sustainability; scope for future work.
Prototype & Demonstration Readiness	5	Evidence of a working module or validated proof of concept; quality of the live demonstration; ability to explain measured results.
Presentation & Format Compliance	5	Clarity of the pitch; adherence to the six-slide SIH Idea Submission format; quality of response to jury questions.
Total	50	

Note. Every team member must be able to explain their individual contribution, and must clearly distinguish student-developed work from externally sourced hardware, software, libraries, datasets and AI-assisted code. Ideas that replicate earlier SIH entries will be marked down under Novelty.

6. Submission and Demonstration Requirements

Idea Presentation. Six slides maximum, in the SIH Idea Submission format: (i) Title — PS ID, PS Title, Theme, PS Category, Team ID, Team Name and Idea Title; (ii) Proposed Solution; (iii) Technical Approach; (iv) Feasibility and Viability; (v) Impact and Benefits; (vi) Research and References. Use points, diagrams and infographics — not paragraphs.

Demonstration display. Mandatory at the table: Team ID and Team Name, PS ID and PS Title, Theme and PS Category, all six members, mentor(s), department, the working prototype or software system, the key innovation and major results. Recommended: system architecture diagram, key performance metrics, and a QR code linking to the demonstration video or code repository.

Backup demonstration. Every team must carry a backup — demonstration video, screenshots, sample datasets or recorded test results. This is a contingency for technical failure at the venue and does not substitute for a live demonstration.

7. Recognition and Awards

Nomination support for SIH 2026 is the principal outcome of SAH 2026. Alongside it, the jury will confer **twenty awards**. There are no Winner and Runner-Up positions: **each award has a single recipient team**.

7.1 Awards 1–17 · Theme Awards

One award is conferred for each of the seventeen themes notified by SIH 2026. In every theme the award goes to the **highest overall score** among the teams registered under that theme, as evaluated on the 50-mark rubric at Section 5.

#	SIH 2026 Theme	Award
1	Smart Automation	Best Team — Smart Automation
2	Smart Education	Best Team — Smart Education
3	Smart Vehicles	Best Team — Smart Vehicles
4	Robotics and Drones	Best Team — Robotics and Drones
5	Agriculture, FoodTech & Rural Development	Best Team — Agriculture, FoodTech & Rural Development
6	MedTech / BioTech / HealthTech	Best Team — MedTech / BioTech / HealthTech
7	Clean & Green Technology	Best Team — Clean & Green Technology
8	Renewable / Sustainable Energy	Best Team — Renewable / Sustainable Energy

#	SIH 2026 Theme	Award
9	Transportation & Logistics	Best Team — Transportation & Logistics
10	Disaster Management	Best Team — Disaster Management
11	Blockchain & Cybersecurity	Best Team — Blockchain & Cybersecurity
12	Space Technology	Best Team — Space Technology
13	Heritage & Culture	Best Team — Heritage & Culture
14	Travel & Tourism	Best Team — Travel & Tourism
15	Fitness & Sports	Best Team — Fitness & Sports
16	Toys and Games	Best Team — Toys and Games
17	Miscellaneous	Best Team — Miscellaneous

7.2 Awards 18–20 · Special Awards

#	Award	Conferred on
18	Best All-Women Team Award	The highest-scoring team composed entirely of women members, across all themes and both PS Categories.
19	Young Innovator Award	The most promising team drawn wholly from first- and second-year students, judged on originality and demonstrated build capability relative to stage of study.
20	Home Ground Challenge Winner Team Award	The best team addressing a Home Ground Challenge — a problem statement raised by the Chennai Campus itself — judged on the quality of the solution and its readiness for deployment on campus.

7.3 What the Awards Carry, and Nomination Support

Recipient	Entitlement
The 20 award-winning teams	A medal and a Certificate of Merit for every team member, together with nomination support for SIH 2026 registration. These twenty teams are default recipients of nomination support.
The next 30 teams in rank order	Nomination support for SIH 2026 registration.
Total selected for nomination support	50 teams — the 20 award-winning teams plus the next 30 in jury rank order.
The top 50 teams	A certificate of merit.
All verified participants	A digital e-participation certificate.

Note. Selection for nomination support is not the same as upload to the national portal. The number of teams the Campus SPOC may finally upload is governed by the SIH nomination ceiling described at Section 4, and teams will be taken from this pool of fifty strictly in jury rank order.

7.4 Award Eligibility and Jury Discretion

- **One award per team.** A team may receive only one of the twenty awards.
- **Awards are not guaranteed.** If no deserving team is found in a particular theme or category, the award will not be conferred.
- **Minimum participation.** A theme that attracts fewer than **five** registered teams will not carry a Theme Award. Selection of teams from that theme for nomination support will nevertheless be carried out on merit.

- **Jury decision.** The decision of the jury is final and binding.
- **Right to amend.** The Organising Committee reserves the right to modify these clauses from time to time, as required and having regard to participation levels, portal notifications and other relevant considerations.

8. General Guidelines

- **Team composition is frozen at the close of registration.** Members cannot be substituted afterwards, and the Team Leader cannot be changed.
- **Reporting is compulsory.** A registered team that does not report for jury evaluation forfeits both its participation certificates and any claim to nomination support.
- **Academic integrity.** Work must be original. All libraries, datasets, APIs, purchased modules and AI-assisted development must be declared and cited. Misrepresentation of third-party work as student-developed will lead to disqualification.
- **Safety.** Projects involving high voltage or current, batteries, motors, lasers, chemicals, biological materials, pressurised systems or rotating machinery must be declared at registration and cleared by the Organising Committee, which may prohibit any demonstration considered unsafe.
- **Event documentation.** Photographs, video and team particulars from SAH 2026 will form part of the Internal Hackathon Report uploaded to the SIH portal by the Campus SPOC, as required of every participating institute.

Violation of any of these guidelines will lead to disqualification. The decision of the Organising Committee is final.

9. Enquiries and Organising Committee

Students may approach the Programme Faculty Coordinator for their own programme in the first instance. Queries of a general nature may be sent to the Organising Committee by email.

#	Organising Committee Member	Programme / Role
1	Dr. Piyush Prathap Singh	Campus SIH 2026 SPoC; Mechanical & RAI Programme Faculty Coordinator
2	Dr. Simhadri Ravishankar	ECE & CCE Programme Faculty Coordinator
3	Mrs. V. Nivethitha	CSE Programme Faculty Coordinator
4	Dr. S. Krishnakumar	AI & AIE Programme Faculty Coordinator
5	Dr. Jinka Venkata Aravind	CYS Programme Faculty Coordinator

Channel	Details
Email	sah@ch.amrita.edu
Website — full details	[website address to be inserted] — problem statements, registration link, formats, FAQs and announcements.

QR CODE

placeholder — insert QR image

Scan for everything about SAH 2026

Problem statements · registration · Idea Submission format · key dates · award list · FAQs

Or write to sah@ch.amrita.edu

Issued by

The Organising Committee, Smart Amrita Hackathon (SAH) 2026

Amrita School of Engineering and Computing, Chennai Campus
